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Daily brief · 2026-07-18

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Last 7 daily reports

3 deep-dives you should really read

Capital One releases VulnHunter, an open-source AI tool that finds software flaws before hackers do

VentureBeat – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** Capital One's VulnHunter is an open-source, agentic AI security tool proactively scanning software source code for exploitable vulnerabilities, identifying attack paths, and proposing fixes.
- **Who:** Developed and released by Capital One, a leading financial institution, this AI tool leverages advanced models like Anthropic's Claude to secure software globally.
- **What it does:** VulnHunter performs attacker-first forward analysis and employs a falsification engine to identify actual exploit paths, generate precise vulnerability alerts, and suggest code remediations.
- **Why it matters:** This tool matters because it enables proactive defense against rapidly evolving AI threats, reducing false positives and strengthening software supply chain security for all.
- **Strategic view:** Capital One is strategically leading collective cybersecurity by open-sourcing advanced AI defense, enhancing industry-wide resilience against sophisticated attacks and fortifying its own digital trust.

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Brex built its AI agent policy by watching what agents actually do, not by writing rules first

VentureBeat – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** Brex developed CrabTrap, an open-source HTTP/HTTPS proxy and policy engine, which intelligently governs AI agent behavior by intercepting network traffic and utilizing an LLM-as-a-judge.
- **Who:** Brex, a financial technology company, developed an innovative AI agent governance platform, championed by co-founder Pedro Franceschi, which has been featured by VentureBeat.
- **What it does:** CrabTrap intercepts AI agent network requests, applying dynamic policy rules and an LLM-as-a-judge to approve or deny actions based on learned behavioral patterns, instead of static pre-set guidelines.
- **Why it matters:** This solution fundamentally shifts AI agent governance from SDK-level permissions to a centralized, adaptive network control plane, enhancing enterprise confidence for broad, secure autonomous agent deployment.
- **Strategic view:** TMT executives should recognize this new paradigm for AI agent governance, enabling secure, scalable enterprise adoption by shifting control to the network layer, fostering trust, and maximizing autonomous capabilities.

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Agents think in milliseconds, legacy infrastructure doesn't. LinkedIn, Walmart and Zendesk shared how they closed the gap at VB Transform 2026

VentureBeat – AI · Topic: **AI/Cloud/Quantum**

- **What it is:** Enterprises are realizing that legacy IT infrastructure, designed for human workflows, is the primary bottleneck for scaling AI agent deployments from pilot to production.
- **Who:** Infrastructure leaders from LinkedIn, Walmart, and Zendesk shared insights at VB Transform 2026 on overcoming AI agent deployment challenges.
- **What it does:** Companies are modernizing infrastructure through pre-provisioned resources, custom orchestration, robust data pipelines, and building model-agnostic gateways for scalable AI agent deployment.
- **Why it matters:** Overcoming these infrastructure hurdles is crucial for enterprises to prevent engineering bottlenecks, scale AI agents from pilot to production, and unlock widespread innovation.
- **Strategic view:** C-level executives must strategically invest in AI-native infrastructure, robust data pipelines, and model-agnostic control flows to ensure scalable agent deployment and maximize future enterprise AI value.

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CEO POV · AI & Space Economy

No CEO statements collected for today.

Patent watch · Compute / Video / Data / Cloud

No relevant patent publications detected for today (EPO / USPTO).

Curated watchlist · 3-5 links per topic

TV / Streaming

No notable articles for this topic today.

Telco / 5G

No notable articles for this topic today.

Media / Platforms

No notable articles for this topic today.

AI / Cloud / Quantum

- [Intuit scrapped its own AI agent architecture twice in four months. At VB Transform 2026, its AI VP called that the fast path](#) (VentureBeat – AI) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [The Download: perimenopause misinformation and China’s latest AI leap](#) (MIT Technology Review – Tech) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [The risk of weather data sabotage is rising](#) (MIT Technology Review – Tech) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [AWS Billing Glitch Hits Customers With Billion-Dollar Fees](#) (Wired – Business) ☐ Add to Weekly
- [Polymarket’s Corporate Structure Is a Mystery—Even to Some of Its Former Employees](#) (Wired – Business) ☐ Add to Weekly

Space / Infrastructure

- [European Service Module team meets Artemis II crew](#) (ESA – European Space Agency) ☐ Add to Weekly

Robotics / Automation

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Broadcast / Video

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Satellite / Satcom

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